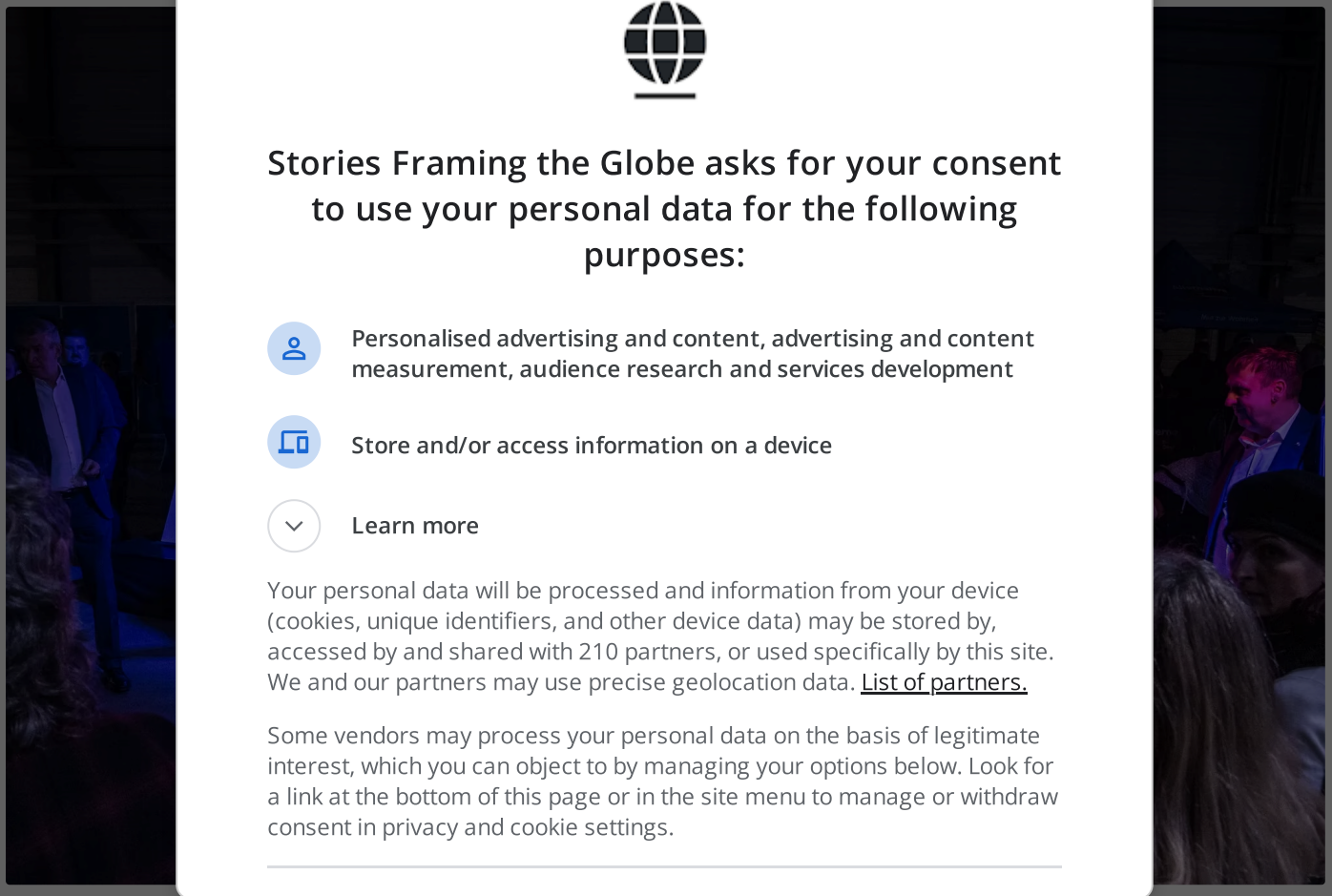
NEWS

A Court Ordered German Security Services to Temporarily Remove AfD's "Confirmed Extremism" Status The Ruling Marked a Party Victory Ahead of Regional Elections

February 26, 2026 Denis Shynkarenko



The New York Times

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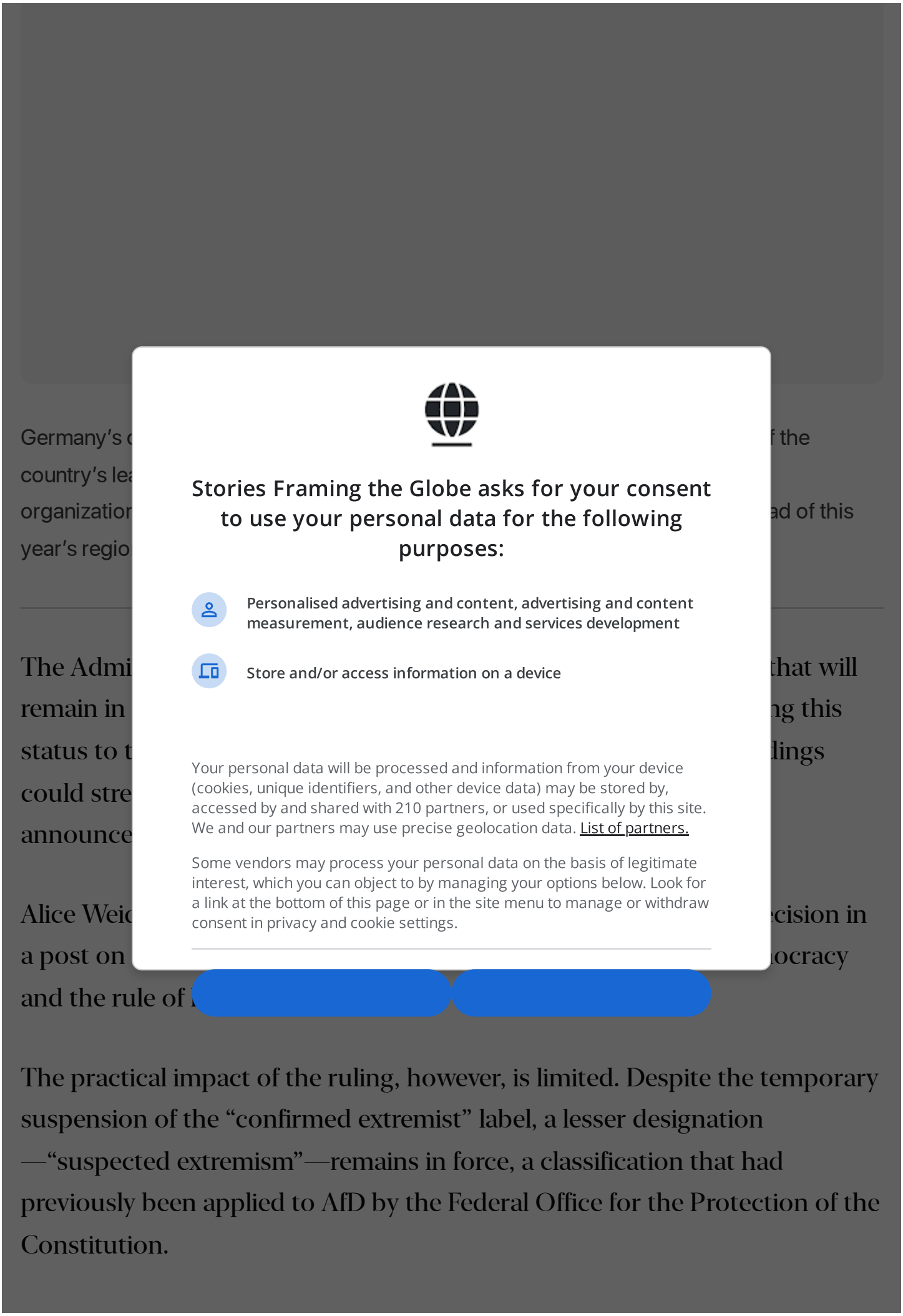

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The practical impact of the ruling, however, is limited. Despite the temporary suspension of the "confirmed extremist" label, a lesser designation —"suspected extremism"—remains in force, a classification that had previously been applied to AfD by the Federal Office for the Protection of the Constitution.

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This means the intelligence service can still deploy nearly its full range of surveillance tools against the party—including wiretapping telephone conversations and the use of paid informants.

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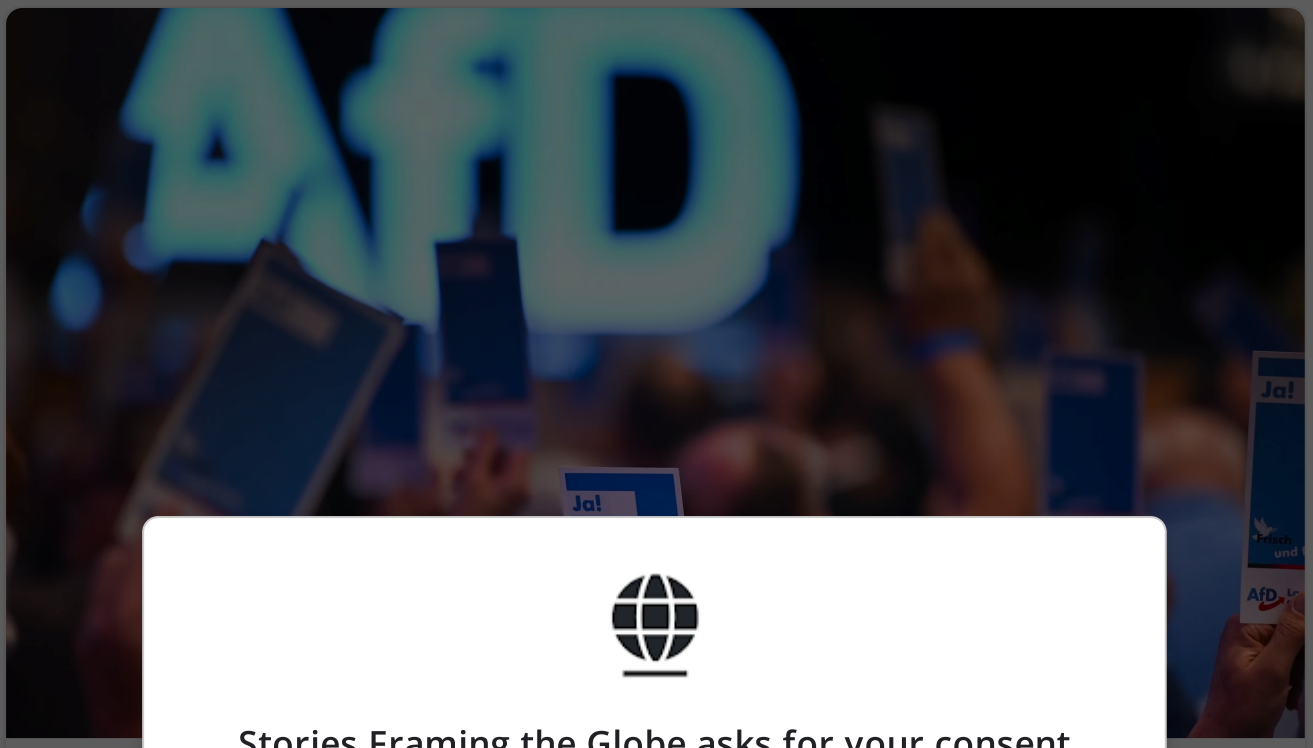
A party th… an establishe… nents now prefer to c… t. In last year's federal election, AfD came second with 21 percent of the vote, and its standing remains strong, according to both national and regional polls.

During televised leaders' debates in last year's campaign, Alice Weidel was given equal airtime alongside representatives of mainstream parties. This week, an AfD candidate was also included in televised debates ahead of the Baden-Württemberg state parliament elections.



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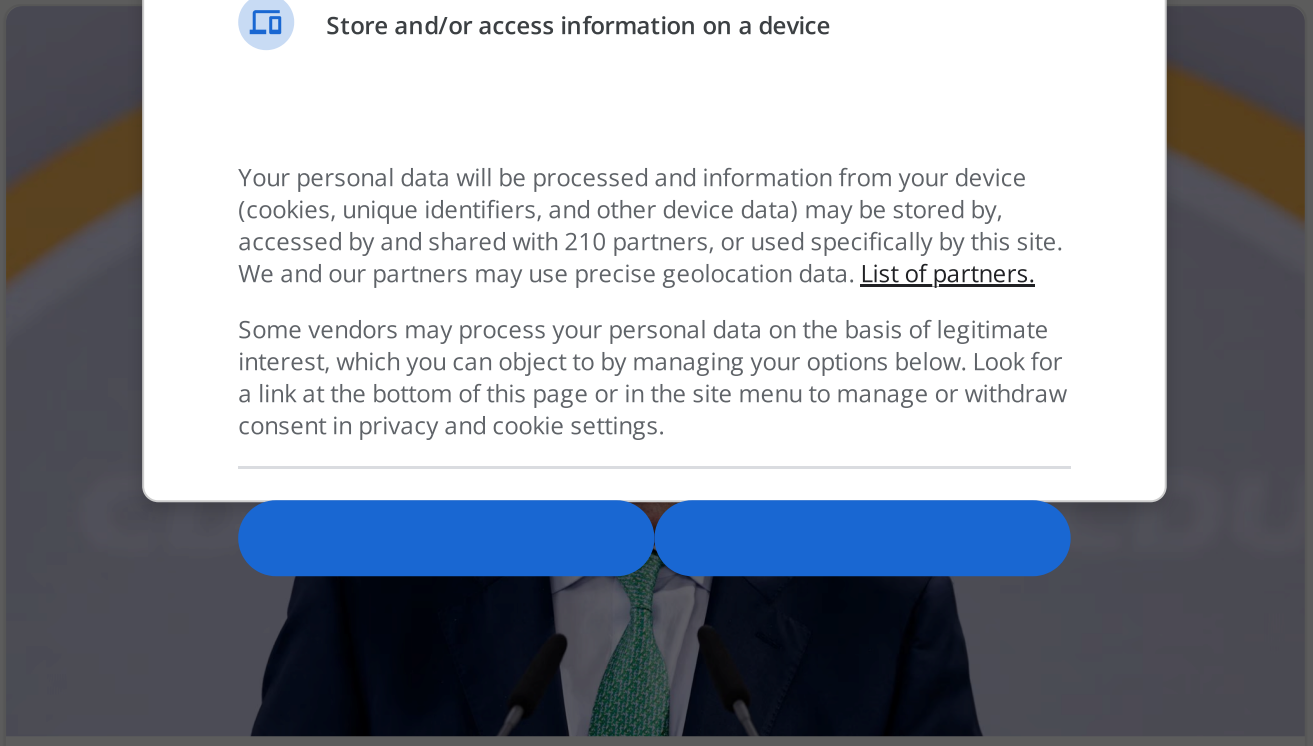

NEWS

Only 23% of Germans Are Satisfied With Chancellor Merz's Performance

Amid Falling Support, Alternative for Germany Is Emerging as the Leading Force

The administration of Donald Trump has publicly defended AfD and other far-right parties in Europe, condemning efforts to isolate them and restrict freedom of expression. In a sharply worded speech in Munich last year, Vice President J.D. Vance effectively criticized Germany's approach to AfD. After the party was designated a "confirmed extremist organization," Secretary of State Marco Rubio described the decision as "tyranny disguised" in a post on X.

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ADVERTISING

The Federal Office for the Protection of the Constitution first designated AfD as a “case for review” on suspicion of extremism in 2019, allowing surveillance to begin. In 2021, the party was classified as “suspected of extremism,” expanding monitoring powers, and last year it was placed in the “confirmed extremist” category.

The court ruling issued on Thursday does not apply to regional intelligence services, which are entitled to assess the activities of the party’s state-level organizati… …ower Saxony de… …making it the fifth st…

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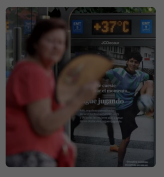

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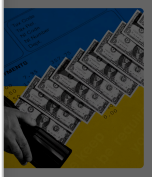

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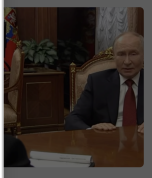

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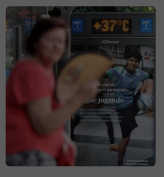

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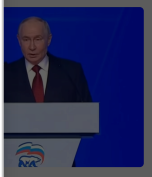

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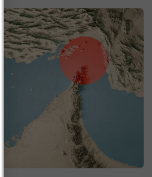

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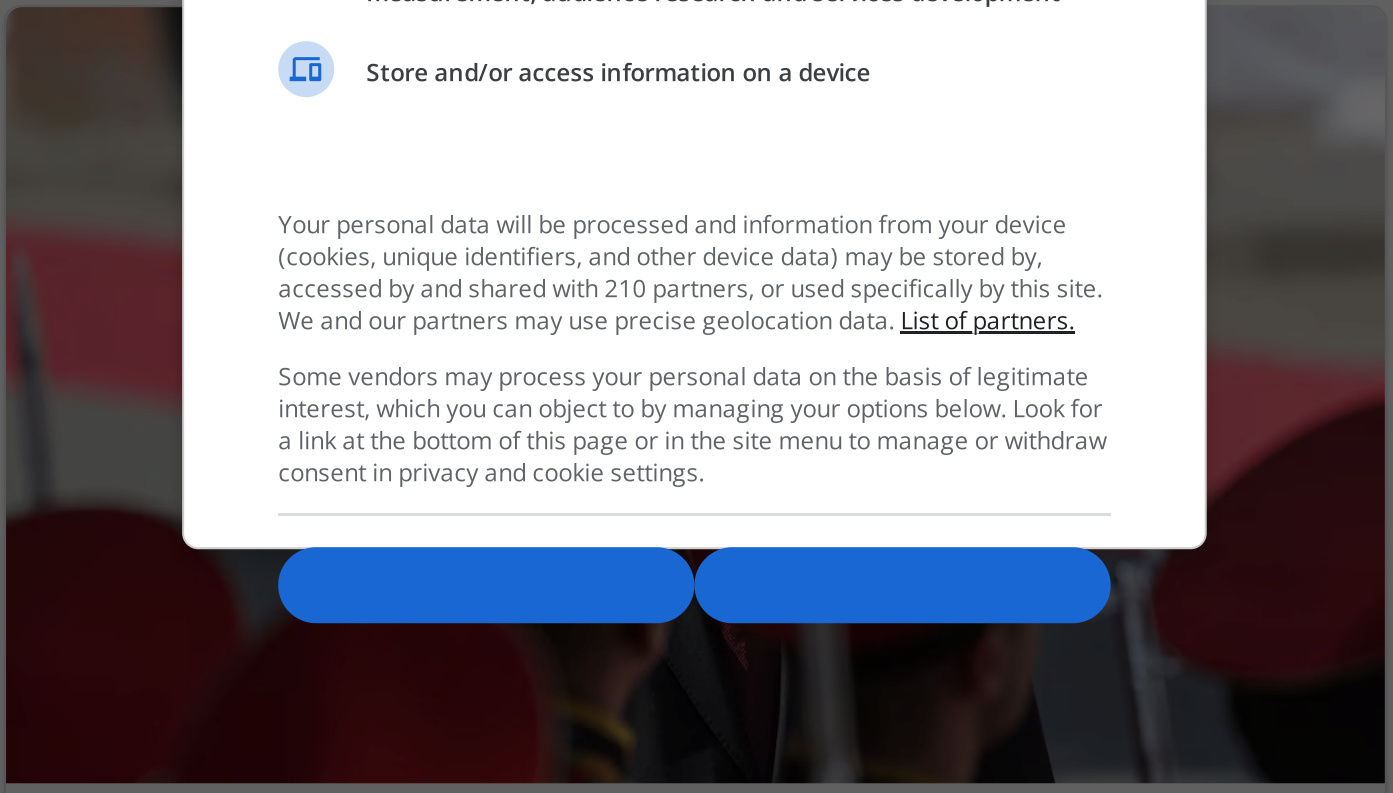

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Vučić Says He Will Resign in Coming Weeks Serbia to Hold Snap Elections After Year and a Half of Protests

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UPA Scandal Escalates Into Mutual Return of Awards Between Ukraine and Poland Behind Historical Agenda Lies Struggle for EU Investment and Regional Leadership

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Harvey Weinstein Fails to Overturn Sexual Assault Conviction But Sentence Will Be Reconsidered After New York Convictions Were Vacated

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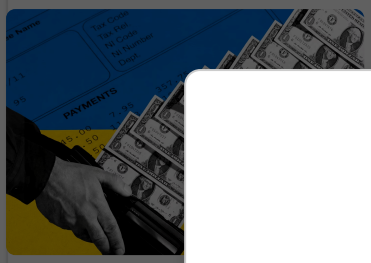

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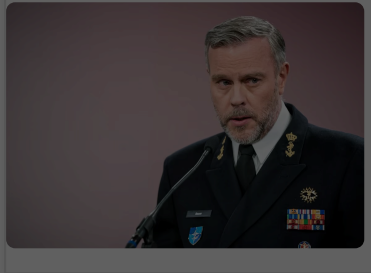

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Former NATO Military Committee Chair Warns Europe of New Dependence on China Rob Bauer Says Green Energy Could Become Same Risk for EU as Russian Gas

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European Commission Proposes Excluding Ukrainian Men From Protection to Avoid "Depleting" Ukraine's Army But Mobilization Itself Involves Detentions Without Legal Grounds, as Complaints Against TCCs Rise Hundreds of Times

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Kremlin Discusses New Wave of Mobilization Sources Say It Could Come in Fall 2026, but No Decision Has Been Made

REPORTAGE

Turkey Turns Ankara Into Fortress Ahead of July 7–8 NATO Summit 70,000 People Deployed for Security as Eco-Activists and Hundreds of Others Detained Before Event

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Trump Unveils Design for "Patriotic Passport" Marking America's 250th Anniversary Limited-Edition Document Features Image of

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Trump to Attend Private Lunch With Republican Senators Amid Party Divisions

Some Openly Question His Iran Policy

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